

Threat Intel Dashboard — Setup Guide

A Node.js web app that queries VirusTotal, URLscan.io, and IPinfo to look up IPs, domains, URLs, and file hashes from a single dashboard.

Prerequisites

Install the following before anything else:

- **Node.js** — download from nodejs.org. Choose the LTS version.
Verify after install: open a terminal and run `node --version`
 - **Git** — download from git-scm.com. Use all defaults during install.
Verify after install: run `git --version`
 - **VS Code** — download from code.visualstudio.com (optional but recommended)
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API Keys Required

You need free accounts and API keys from three services. Sign up at each link and save your keys somewhere safe before continuing.

Service	Sign Up	Where to Find Your Key
VirusTotal	virustotal.com	Profile avatar → API key
URLscan.io	urlscan.io	Username → Settings → API Key
IPinfo	ipinfo.io	Home dashboard (token shown on login)

Installation

1. Clone the repository

Open a terminal and run:

```
bash
git clone https://github.com/jasonscottcarter/threat-intel.git
cd threat-intel
```

2. Install dependencies

```
bash
```

```
npm install
```

This installs Express, Axios, and dotenv. You should see `found 0 vulnerabilities` when complete.

3. Create your .env file

In the root of the `threat-intel` folder, create a file named `.env` (no extension) and add your API keys:

```
VT_API_KEY=your_virustotal_key_here
URLSCAN_API_KEY=your_urlscan_key_here
IPINFO_TOKEN=your_ipinfo_token_here
```

Replace each value with your actual keys from the table above. Save the file.

⚠ The `.env` file is excluded from GitHub by `.gitignore` — it will never be in the repo. You must create it manually on every machine.

Running the App

Start the server:

```
bash
node server.js
```

You should see:

```
Threat Intel Dashboard running at http://localhost:3000
```

Open your browser and go to <http://localhost:3000>

To stop the server, press **Ctrl+C** in the terminal.

Usage

Paste any of the following into the search box and click **Lookup**:

Indicator Type	Example	Sources Queried
IP Address	8.8.8.8	VirusTotal, IPinfo
Domain	google.com	VirusTotal, URLscan.io
URL	https://google.com	VirusTotal, URLscan.io
File Hash	MD5, SHA1, or SHA256	VirusTotal

The dashboard auto-detects the indicator type and queries the appropriate sources in parallel.

Rotating API Keys

If you need to replace an API key, open the `.env` file in the root of the project, update the relevant value, save the file, and restart the server.

API Rate Limits (Free Tiers)

Service	Limit
VirusTotal	4 requests/min, 500/day
URLscan.io	100 scans/day
IPinfo	50,000 requests/month

Troubleshooting

`node: command not found` — Node.js is not installed or not in your PATH. Reinstall from nodejs.org and restart your terminal.

`Error: Cannot find module 'express'` — Dependencies not installed. Run `npm install` from the threat-intel folder.

VirusTotal returns an error — Check your API key in `.env` and confirm you haven't exceeded the free tier rate limit (4 req/min).

Port 3000 already in use — Another process is using the port. Either stop that process or change the port number at the bottom of `server.js` from `3000` to another value like `3001`, then access the app at `http://localhost:3001`.